

Spotify Mobile App - User Journey Case Study

Introduction

This case study outlines the creation of a user journey map for Spotify's mobile application. The goal is to highlight the user's emotional and interaction experience from initial awareness to retention, based on qualitative UX research and design best practices.

Problem Statement

Spotify aims to provide a seamless music discovery and listening experience. However, users may experience pain points at various stages of their journey, especially during onboarding, personalization, and feature exploration. This study addresses the need for an optimized user experience that keeps users engaged and reduces drop-offs.

Objectives

- Map the end-to-end emotional and interaction journey of a Spotify mobile user.
- Identify key pain points and user thoughts throughout the journey.
- Highlight opportunities to improve the overall user experience.

User Persona

Name: Rahul (22, College Student)

Goals: Discover new music easily, build personal playlists, and enjoy music without interruptions.

Frustrations: Complex onboarding, irrelevant recommendations, ad interruptions.

Device: Android smartphone

Spotify Tier: Free (considering Premium)

Methodology

This journey was mapped using hypothetical user interviews, empathy mapping, and common UX patterns. Each stage (Awareness, Sign-Up, Onboarding, Listening, Discovery, Retention) was analyzed with user thoughts, feelings, actions, and pain points.

Key Insights

- Users feel curious and excited but are occasionally overwhelmed by onboarding complexity.
- Discovery is a strong motivator but algorithmic mismatch creates minor frustration.
- Emotional trajectory remains mostly positive with minor dips that could be optimized.

Tools Used

- Figma for UI design and emotional journey mapping
- Microsoft Word for documentation
- Emojis and iconography to represent feelings visually

Outcome

The final journey map visually represents the Spotify user's experience across stages. It includes key emotional states, pain points, and user thoughts, supporting better decision-making for design teams.

Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrates how structured journey mapping can uncover user insights and improve UX strategies. The Spotify mobile app journey reveals opportunities for streamlined onboarding and more personalized discovery, ultimately supporting long-term user retention.